

Package `paracol`: Yet Another Multi-Column Package to Typeset Columns in *Parallel*

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Abstract

This package provides a L^AT_EX environment named `paracol` in which you may *switch* and *synchronize* columns by a command `\switchcolumn` and by internal environments `column`, `nthcolumn`, `leftcolumn` and `rightcolumn`. See p. 59 for the table of contents of this manual, see [paracol.pdf](#) for code documentation.

1 Introduction

This document describes the usage of yet another multi-column package named `paracol`. The unique feature of the package is that columns are typeset *in parallel*.

Suppose you are writing a bilingual document whose left column is written in a language, say English, and right column has the translation of the left column in another language, e.g., Japanese. With the `paracol` package you may write an English part of arbitrarily length and then *switch* to its Japanese counterpart to place both parts side by side. Of course you may return to the English writing similarly.

The *column-switching* is always allowed when you complete an outermost level paragraph. You may be unaware whether a column is broken into multiple pages before switching because the package automatically goes back and forward to the correct page and vertical position when you switch the column. Moreover, you may *synchronize* columns so that the tops of the first paragraphs after switching in all columns are vertically aligned. At a synchronization point, you may give a single-column text, for example a common section header, optionally. You may also switch single-column and multi-column in a page arbitrary.

This manual itself is an example of two-column

```
\begin{paracol}{2}[\section{Introduction}]
\hbadness5000
```

```
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